

interface

The means by which the user interacts with software or hardware. See *GUI*.

library

A collection of functions that can be reused in other projects.

list

A collection of items stored in numbered order.

local variable

A variable that works only within a limited part of a program, such as a function. See also *global variable*.

loop

A part of a program that repeats itself, removing the need to type out the same piece of code multiple times.

module

A package of ready-made code that can be imported into a Python program, making lots of useful functions available.

nested loop

A loop inside another loop.

operating system (OS)

The program that controls everything on a computer, such as Windows, macOS, or Linux.

operator

A symbol that performs a specific function: for example, “+” (addition) or “-” (subtraction).

output

Data that is produced by a computer program and viewed by the user.

parameter

A value given to a function. The value of a parameter is assigned by the line of code that calls the function.

pixels

Tiny dots that make up a digital image.

program

A set of instructions that a computer follows in order to complete a task.

programming language

A language that is used to give instructions to a computer.

Python

A popular programming language created by Guido van Rossum. It is a great language for beginners to learn.

random

A function in a computer program that allows unpredictable outcomes. Useful when creating games.

recursion

Creating a loop by telling a function to call itself.

return value

The variable or data that is passed back after a function has been called (run).

run

The command to make a program start.

software

Programs that run on a computer and control how it works.

statement

The smallest complete instruction a programming language can be broken down into.

string

A series of characters. Strings can contain numbers, letters, or symbols, such as a colon.

syntax

The rules that determine how code must be written in order for it to work properly.

toggle

To switch between two different settings.

tuple

A list of items separated by commas and surrounded by brackets. Tuples are similar to lists, except you can't change them after they've been created.

turtle graphics

A Python module that lets you draw shapes by moving a robotic turtle across the screen.

Unicode

A universal code used by computers to represent thousands of symbols and text characters.

variable

A place to store data that can change in a program, such as the player's score. A variable has a name and a value.

widget

A part of a Tkinter GUI (graphical user interface) that performs a specific function, such as a button or menu.